

Snakes

There are several thousand different types of snakes. Most of them are not venomous or dangerous to people, and many are beautiful, with bright colours and patterns. All snakes swallow their prey whole.

WHAT MAKES A SNAKE?

Snakes are cold-blooded and need outside heat, like the Sun, to keep warm. A snake smells with its tongue and "hears" by picking up vibrations.



LIDLESS EYES



COLD-BLOODED



NO EARS



FORKED TONGUE

COLUBRIDS

With their diverse colours and sizes, the colubrids make up a very large group. Few of them are venomous. Some kill by constriction.



EASTERN PINE SNAKE



DIADEM SNAKE



CALIFORNIA KINGSNAKE



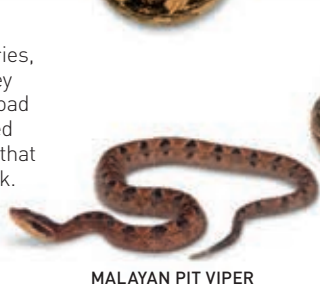
LAVENDER STRIPED KINGSNAKE



RED CORNSNAKE

VIPERS

Found in nearly all countries, vipers are venomous. They have squat bodies and broad heads. Some have infrared sensors under their eyes that help them hunt in the dark.



MALAYAN PIT VIPER



GABOON VIPER



WESTERN DIAMOND-BACKED RATTLESNAKE



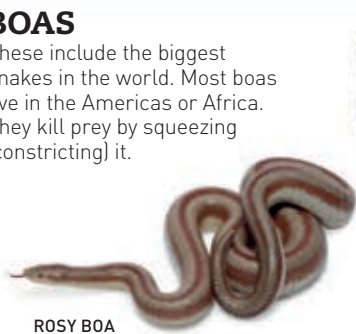
TAYLOR'S CANTIL VIPER



FER-DE-LANCE

BOAS

These include the biggest snakes in the world. Most boas live in the Americas or Africa. They kill prey by squeezing (constricting) it.



ROSY BOA



COOK'S TREE BOA



RUBBER BOA



RAINBOW BOA



EAST AFRICAN SAND BOA

COBRAS AND RELATIVES

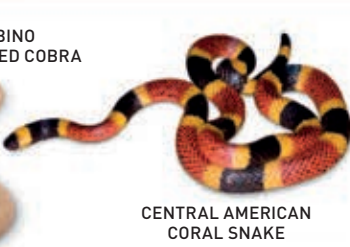
All cobras are venomous. Some have very fast-acting poisons strong enough to kill large animals, or a human.



EGYPTIAN COBRA



ALBINO MONOCLED COBRA



CENTRAL AMERICAN CORAL SNAKE



RED SPITTING COBRA



KING COBRA

PYTHONS

These often very big constricting snakes come from Asia and Africa. Some types are popular as pets.



BURMESE PYTHON



ALBINO BURMESE PYTHON



SPOTTED PYTHON

INSIDE A SNAKE

A snake's inner organs are designed to fit in a long, narrow space. These organs are very stretchy, allowing prey to be swallowed whole.

A SNAKE'S HEART CAN SHIFT AROUND TO AVOID INJURY FROM SWALLOWED PREY

